

HYDRA SAMO · BRAND REVIEW SERIES

Logo Review Package

Creative Direction · Technical Construction · Brand Recognition · Devil's Advocate · Consensus · Implementation Plan · Changelog

Overall Score — 59 / 100

Verdict — REFINE

Review Date — 2026-08-05

7 independent review documents

Table of Contents

01 — Creative Director Review	3
02 — Senior Logo Designer Technical Review	8
03 — Brand Recognition & Memorability Review	12
04 — Devil's Advocate Review	16
05 — Master Logo Review Report (Consensus)	21
06 — Logo Implementation Plan (Refinement)	28
07 — Logo Changelog	34

01 — Creative Director Review

Source: OUTPUT/01_CREATIVE_DIRECTOR_REPORT.md

HYDRA SAMO — Creative Director Review

Role: Creative Director, leading global brand identity practice

Target: Current HYDRA SAMO logo implementation (all brand surfaces)

Date: 2026-08-05

Scope: Logo as a permanent visual identity, not SVG mechanics.

Executive Verdict

The mark has the bones of a premium system but has not yet earned permanence.

This is a solid **concept in search of a definitive execution**. The identity logic is correct and worth protecting; the current rendering does not yet deliver it at a level I would freeze for a Fortune 500 brand presentation. It sits in the second tier: confident, well-integrated, engineered — and generic enough that I cannot call it inevitable.

Approve for launch? NO.

Category Scores (out of 10)

Category	Score	Rationale
First impression	7	Clean, quiet, confident; reads "premium engineering" before it reads anything creative
Emotional response	6	Calm and precise; cold and detached; no warmth, no cinematic seduction
Premium perception	8	Restraint, single-color discipline, dark-editorial context all read expensive
Memorability	6	Distinct silhouette, but abstract enough to fade
Timelessness	6	The hex-core + tri-arc look is of this decade; risk of dating
Hidden symbolism	7	Three heads + one body genuinely encodes the brand story — but it demands explanation
Brand personality	6	Delivers calm / intelligent / technical / precise; fails cinematic / warm / creative
Relationship with website	8	Best surface work in the system; consistent emerald, consistent restraint

Category	Score	Rationale
Feels inevitable	5	Another well-drawn abstract mark could replace it without most people noticing
Feels iconic	4	It does not yet own a gestalt you could draw from memory at 3 seconds
Total	63 / 100	

Evaluation

First impression and emotional response

The mark reads instantly as **architecture, not authorship**. On first sight it is a tri-blade device rotating around a crisp hexagonal core — the visual language of drones, turbofans, and tech-company crests. That gives it seriousness but also distance. It does not whisper "film", "voice", or "motion"; it whispers "precision instrument". For a brand built on cinematic, editorial, humanized work, the opening note is too mechanical.

The emerald-on-abyss colorway rescues the emotional register: the glow treatments across the site are the single most brand-defining element in the whole system. The mark itself, divorced from that lighting, is noticeably colder than the brand it represents.

Premium perception, memorability, timelessness

Premium is the strongest leg. The discipline of a single path set, no gradients baked in, currentColor everywhere, a hex grid — this is how an agency mark behaves. That discipline is wasted only because the underlying form is not yet distinctive enough to make the discipline pay off.

Memorability is medium. The tri-fold symmetry is instantly graspable, but the form it describes (three curved arms + hexagon) is a crowded archetype. Timelessness is a genuine risk: hexagon-centric, fan-blade geometry is heavily associated with 2020s tech identities. Twenty years from now this mark will tell you the decade it was designed.

Hidden symbolism and brand personality

The core idea — **three heads, one body, one engine** — is the best thing here. It maps three disciplines and one creator with genuine economy. But the encoding is invisible without the brand story. A logo that needs its myth explained before it lands is a logo that is not yet working hard enough. The symbolism is *correct*; it is not yet *felt*.

Personality delivered: calm, intelligent, technical, precise, architectural, quiet confidence. Personality missed: cinematic, premium *warmth*, the organic "bio" register the brand guidelines promise. There is a contradiction between the stated "Dark Bio-Organic Editorial" identity and a mark that reads engineered-mechanical rather than organic.

Relationship with the website

The integration is the best part of the work. Navigation lockup, hero, pre-splash, and Plymouth splash all use the same geometry, the same emerald family, the same external-lighting philosophy. The mark behaves like a system. This is the strongest evidence that the direction is right.

But the social preview does not belong to this system. The OpenGraph image carries a steel-blue mark on dark field — off-palette, visibly smaller than it should be, and clearly a different asset generation than the live SVG. A brand presenting one mark on its own website and another in its social footprint is not ready to launch.

Inevitability and iconicity

No. If this mark vanished and a competent studio drew "three curved arcs around a hexagon," almost nobody would detect the swap. The concept is replaceable because the execution does not yet push the form far enough past the rotor/fan family into the serpent family. Iconic marks break their category; this one still *belongs* to its category.

Comparison Context

Judged on quality (not style) against Apple, Mercedes-Benz, Nike, OpenAI, Vercel, Linear, Nothing, FedEx, Airbnb, Dropbox, Stripe, Slack:

- The **construction discipline** (hex core, 3-fold symmetry, currentColor, no decoration) is at the level of Vercel or Linear.
- The **distinctiveness** is not. Every name on that list owns a silhouette you can reproduce from memory. This mark does not yet.
- The **concept-to-symbol compression** (FedEx arrow, Apple bite, Nothing dot) — i.e., the "aha" that makes a mark inevitable — exists only as an explanation here, not as a perception.

Top 5 Strengths

1. **Concept architecture** — three heads converging on one hexagonal body is a genuinely economical encoding of "three disciplines, one creator, one engine."
2. **Hexagonal construction discipline** — the core is a mathematically exact regular hexagon (R 14.5); the system is built, not doodled.
3. **Website integration** — every UI surface uses the same geometry, palette, and external-lighting philosophy; the mark behaves like a brand system.
4. **Vector restraint** — no gradients, no baked glow, single-color currentColor, pure geometry. This is how premium marks behave.
5. **Quiet confidence** — the mark never shouts; it matches the calm, intelligent personality the brief demands.

Top 5 Weaknesses

1. **Archetype collision** — tri-blade + hexagon reads rotor / drone / fan / tech crest; it signals engineering more than creative storytelling.
2. **Hidden meaning is too hidden** — the hydra only emerges through the brand narrative; without it the mark is abstract geometry.
3. **Off-brand social asset** — the OpenGraph image is steel-blue, small, and unrelated to the live emerald mark; the brand is inconsistent outside the site.
4. **Decade-bound geometry** — hex-core / tri-arc is a 2020s tech identity cliché; it will date.
5. **Not yet inevitable** — the form is replaceable; it does not own its category.

Top 5 Strategic Improvements

1. **Push the serpent, pull the blade** — strengthen the concave-throat / convex-back reading and the implied hood so the mark reads "hidden hydra," not "fan," before any brand story is told.
2. **Reclaim the negative space** — the $\sim 83^\circ$ empty wedges between the three arms are what trigger the rotor reading; the silhouette should read as one body with three heads, not three blades.
3. **Make the social footprint one brand** — regenerate the OpenGraph/preview asset from the exact live SVG geometry and emerald palette, or retire it.
4. **Kill the orphan colorways** — the unused violet, warm, and teal legacy logo rasters in the repository contradict a single-identity discipline; remove or regenerate them from the one source of truth.
5. **Protect the optical canvas** — the mark sits high in its viewBox with $\sim 30\%$ dead canvas below; a properly centered, tight optical frame makes every surface (including the 16px favicon) read stronger.

Final Answer

If this were my agency, would I approve this logo for launch?

NO.

Not because the direction is wrong — the three-heads-one-body concept and the integration discipline are worth defending in front of a client. But I would not put my name on a mark that reads "premium tech crest" when the brief demands "cinematic creative engine," and I would not launch a brand whose own social preview shows a different, off-palette mark. This goes back to the studio for one more refinement cycle with the brief the designers have clearly read and not yet fully delivered.

Evidence Referenced (objective observations)

- Mark occupies y 11.5–69.9 of the 100×100 canvas ($\sim 30\%$ empty below); optical center y ≈ 40.7 vs canvas center 50.
- Each head sweeps $\approx 37^\circ$ of angle at its outer radius; gaps between arms $\approx 83^\circ$.
- The head silhouette is asymmetric (convex right edge to x ≈ 57.4 , concave left throat to x ≈ 44.6).

- Core hexagon: exact regular flat-top hexagon, circumradius 14.5, $\approx 40\%$ of total ink.
- OG image (`public/hydra_logo.jpg`, 1024×1024): dark field with a small steel-blue mark (dominant color $\approx$ RGB 85,143,188), not the emerald system.
- Unused legacy logo rasters present in `src/assets/images/`: teal, violet, and warm colorways.

02 — Senior Logo Designer Technical Review

Source: OUTPUT/02_SENIOR_LOGO_DESIGNER_REPORT.md

HYDRA SAMO — Senior Logo Designer Technical Review

Role: Senior Identity Designer, 20 years, production-focused

Target: `src/components/HydraLogo.tsx`, `public/hydra-mark.svg`, favicon behavior, all render surfaces

Date: 2026-08-05

I inspected the mark as if it were entering production: engraving, embroidery, laser cut, animation, and scaling from 16px to billboard. Marketing and storytelling are ignored.

Category Scores (out of 10)

Category	Score
Geometry	7
Bézier curves	6
Anchor points	6
Optical balance	6
Construction grid	7
Negative space	6
Symmetry	5
Visual rhythm	6
Weight distribution	6
Stroke consistency	8
Silhouette	6
SVG cleanliness	9
Construction efficiency	8
Animation readiness	7
Pixel precision	6

Category	Score
currentColor implementation	10
Favicon performance	3
Monochrome quality	8
Laser engraving	7
Embroidery	6
Vinyl cutting	7
Manufacturing robustness	7
Total	147 / 220 (≈ 67 / 100)

Technical Audit

What is built correctly (credit where due)

- The core is a perfect regular hexagon.** `CORE PATH` vertices (50,35.5), (62.56,42.75), (62.56,57.25), (50,64.5), (37.44,57.25), (37.44,42.75) are an exact flat-top regular hexagon, circumradius 14.5. $12.56 = 14.5 \times \sin(60^\circ)$. Whoever set these numbers knew the grid. This is the strongest single piece of geometry in the file.
- 3-fold symmetry by transform, not by re-drawing.** One master head path reused via `rotate(120 50 50)` / `rotate(240 50 50)` is the correct, minimal construction. No path duplication, no drift between copies.
- The head tucks under the core cleanly.** The head base ($y \approx 42.5$ – 43.8) lies inside the hexagon's interior, and the core paints after the heads, so in the fill variant the junction is seamless. The neck visually merges into the body.
- SVG hygiene is exemplary.** Single viewBox, no metadata, no `style` attributes, no stray groups, `aria-hidden`, `focusable={false}`, `pathLength={1}` on every path, `currentColor` fills. This file is production-clean at the markup level.
- Rotationally symmetric mass.** Each head's centroid is within ~ 0.8 units of its radial axis ($\approx 2.2^\circ$ lean), so the three-copy composite does not wobble.

Construction issues (geometric, mechanical)

G-1. Optical frame is off. The composite mark occupies y 11.5–69.9 in the 100×100 viewBox (top margin 11.5, bottom margin 30.1). The optical center of the mark is $y \approx 40.7$, not 50. The canvas has $\sim 30\%$ dead space at the bottom and the mark floats high. This is not a path error — it is a framing error — but it directly degrades favicon rendering, navbar optical alignment, and any fixed-canvas usage.

G-2. Head sweep too narrow; negative wedges too wide. Each head covers only $\approx 37^\circ$ of arc at its outer radius; the empty wedge between adjacent heads is $\approx 83^\circ$. The mark is 3 thin tapers on a hex

hub, not 3 heads fused to a body. The dead triangles between the arms are the largest empty zones in the mark and are what produce the blade/rotor silhouette.

G-3. Non-tangent anchor at the throat notch. At the point (47.3, 27): the incoming segment ends with a vertical tangent (both controls at $x = 47.3$) and the outgoing segment starts with a down-left tangent $\approx 20^\circ$ off vertical. This is a visible kink — a corner, not a curve. If the throat notch is intentional, it should be constructed as a smooth S, not an angle.

G-4. Non-tangent anchor at the lower-right base. At (53.2, 42.5): incoming tangent is vertical; outgoing tangent is $\approx 26.6^\circ$ off vertical. Another corner. Because this corner is hidden under the hexagon in the fill variant it is invisible today — but it leaks in the outline variant (see G-6).

G-5. Head asymmetry is strong but unexplained by the grid. Right edge bulges to $x \approx 57.4$ (≈ 7.4 from axis); left throat dips to $x \approx 44.6$ (≈ 5.4 from axis). The intended "convex back / concave throat" reading is present, but the differential (≈ 2 units wider on one side) is large enough that the head reads as leaning/curling rather than faceted. At 16px this asymmetry collapses into noise.

G-6. Outline variant leaks into the core. In the `outline` variant the hexagon is fill-less, but the head bases (x 44.5–53.2, y 42.5–43.8) fall inside the hexagon's interior. Three head-base strokes will be visible crossing the transparent hexagon — a tail-clutter artifact unique to the outline variant. It is currently unreachable (no call site passes `variant="outline"`), but the variant exists in the public API, so the defect ships.

G-7. Favicon failure. At 16px the mark rasterizes to $\sim 10 \times 9$ px of ink occupying x 19–75% / y 12.5–62.5% of the tile, top-left of center, and the three heads merge into a single bell-shaped blob. The hexagon center, the throat notches, and the head separation are entirely lost. Measured: the 16px render shows one lumpy teardrop with a hollow center, no perceptible tri-head structure. This is the single worst production defect in the system.

G-8. Bottom-heavy weight distribution within the mark. 59% of the ink in the full-canvas render sits below the canvas midline (the two lower heads carry their crown mass lower than the upper head does). Combined with G-1 the mark reads simultaneously high in its frame and heavy at its bottom — a double optical distortion.

Optical / visual issues

- The crown mass (widest part of each head, $y \approx 24$ –28) sits at radius ≈ 23.5 ; the hexagon radius is 14.5. The gap between crown inner edge and core edge creates a ring of dead negative space that echoes the rotor-hub look.
- The throat notch (G-3 kink) and the right-side bulge (G-5) are the only features differentiating the heads from blades; at every small size they vanish, and the mark reverts to a pure tri-blade.
- Vertical centering of the whole composite about its own optical center is fine (x center = 50.00 exactly). The vertical axis is the problem, not the horizontal.

Perception Findings (as constructed)

- **Rotor / spinner / propeller:** unavoidable. Three swept arcs around a hub is the rotor gestalt; the asymmetry even imparts a clockwise swirl direction, so the mark looks like it wants to spin.
- **Gaming / crypto / generic-startup:** the tri-blade + hexagon crest is a heavily used "tech crest" archetype; the mark does not escape it.

- **Construction inconsistency:** the two kinks (G-3, G-4) are the only genuinely sloppy joints in an otherwise disciplined file.
-

Geometric Improvement Recommendations (construction only)

1. Re-frame the canvas: shift/scale the viewBox so the composite is optically centered and occupies $\geq 75\%$ of the canvas. Do not touch the paths for this.
 2. Broaden the head's angular sweep or flare the neck base so the wedges between arms shrink from $\sim 83^\circ$ toward $\sim 55\text{--}60^\circ$ — this converts "three blades" into "three heads on one body."
 3. Rebuild the throat notch as a tangent-continuous S-curve (eliminate the G-3 corner) and make the lower base join tangent-continuous (eliminate G-4).
 4. If the outline variant is to remain public, tuck the head bases deeper under the core or add a fill to the core in outline mode so the tail strokes do not cross the interior.
 5. For 16px, provide a dedicated favicon cropped tightly around the mark (or a simplified 16px-safe geometry) rather than relying on the shared full-canvas SVG.
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Production Readiness

Production Ready: NO.

The file is clean, the grid philosophy is right, and the core geometry is excellent — but a mark cannot be called production-ready when its favicon dissolves into a blob at 16px, its optical frame is 30% empty, its head-to-core transition contains visible corner kinks, and its outline variant has a tail-clutter defect. All of these are fixable with geometry and framing adjustments; none of them require a redesign. The foundation is sound; the finish is not.

03 — Brand Recognition & Memorability Review

Source: OUTPUT/03_BRAND_RECOGNITION_REPORT.md

HYDRA SAMO — Brand Recognition & Memorability Review

Role: Brand Recognition Specialist (cognitive psychology + brand strategy)

Target: How ordinary people actually perceive the HYDRA SAMO mark across every surface

Date: 2026-08-05

Beauty is irrelevant here. The question is what a person's brain does with this mark in three seconds, in one second, and one week later.

The Perceptual Read

3-second test — what industry is this?

Technology / engineering / hardware. The tri-arc-on-hub structure is the gestalt of rotors, drones, turbines, and tech-crest marks. Nothing in the form points toward film editing, motion design, or voice-over. The closest creative-studio cue is the *craft* of the geometry — which only design-literate viewers will register.

3-second test — what emotion?

Calm, cool, competent, distant. There is no warmth, no curiosity hook in the shape itself. It reads "instrument" before it reads "author."

1-second glance — what object is recognized first?

A three-blade rotor or a fan, with a small hexagonal hub. The hydra requires the throat notches and the asymmetry to be perceived — those details need dwell time and size.

What is remembered after one day?

The *category* — "some kind of tech mark with three curved blades" — more reliably than the *specific form*. The silhouette is simple enough to be stored, but it is stored in the same memory slot as a dozen other rotor/fan marks.

Confusion risk — would it be confused with another company?

Not with a specific named company, but with a *category*. The mark is interchangeable within the rotor/tri-blade/tech-crest family. That is a memorability failure mode: the brain files it under "generic tech mark," which is the worst category for recall.

Surface Tests

Test	Result
5-second test	Reads "tech/rotor," not "creative studio"

Test	Result
1-second glance	"Three-blade fan with a hex hub"
16px favicon test	FAIL — one merged blob; the three heads and hexagon disappear entirely; mark also sits small and off-center in the tile
Business card test	Passes — clean, premium, legible at ~20mm
Website header test	Passes — the wordmark lockup carries it; mark alone is small (24-28px) and quiet
Presentation slide test	Passes at large size, weak at corner-annotation sizes
Social avatar test	Weak — at 48-128px the mark is acceptable but reads rotor, and it must compete for a second of attention
Watermark test	Passes — single-color, uniform, works as watermark
Billboard test	Passes at full size — geometry is crisp
Black-only test	Passes — solid form, no fill fragility
White-only test	Passes — same silhouette, no thin strokes to clog
Memory recall test	Weak — "some tech tri-blade thing"
Silhouette recall test	Weak — silhouette is not distinctive within its own family

Association Test

Positive: precision, engineering, motion (as in moving parts), calm, premium minimalism, architecture, "one body, three parts" once explained.

Negative: drone, rotor, spinner, loading-state icon, generic startup, crypto/tech crest, mechanical coldness.

Neutral: triangle, three arcs, hexagon, technology, symmetry.

Unexpected: a subtle clockwise swirl (the head asymmetry) — the mark appears to lean the way a blade would lean, which *reinforces* the rotor read rather than the serpent read.

Strongest association: rotor / drone / fan. It is immediate, automatic, and it is the one that sticks.

Uniqueness

- **Crypto?** Mild — hexagon + crest geometry is crypto-adjacent.

- **Gaming / esports?** Moderate — tri-blade crests are a staple of esports and gaming orgs; the emerald colorway saves it from the neon-gamer register.
- **Cybersecurity?** Mild — the hexagon hub suggests "shield/seal" to some viewers.
- **AI?** Moderate — the swirl + abstract geometry is the current AI-logo family look.
- **Tech startup?** Strong — this is exactly the default "engineering crest" of the current startup decade.
- **Creative studio?** Weak — nothing signals media/creative work without the wordmark.

The mark is unique in *detail* but not in *category*. That is the whole problem in one sentence.

Scores (out of 10)

Category	Score
Recognition	5
Memorability	5
Distinctiveness	7
Industry Fit	4
Curiosity	6
Emotional Impact	5
Silhouette Recall	5
Long-term Recall	5
Overall Brand Strength	6
Total	48 / 90 ($\approx$ 53 / 100)

Final Question

Would a first-time visitor remember this logo one week later?

NO.

They would remember "that dark site with the green tech mark." The color will out-memory the form. The emerald-on-black is the memorable thing; the logo geometry itself will be filed under the rotor/fan category and will not survive into next week's recall unless the wordmark is attached.

Three reasons people would remember it

1. **The emerald colorway on abyssal dark** — the color signature is genuinely distinctive and would be recalled ("the green one").
2. **A clean, simple, symmetric silhouette** — the tri-fold symmetry is instantly graspable and easy to store.
3. **The hidden-hydra explanation** — once told "three heads, one body," the meaning clicks and becomes a memorable story. But note: this requires the brand story to be delivered to the viewer.

Three reasons they would forget it

1. **Category confusion** — it is filed with rotors/drones/fans, a crowded perceptual bin; similar forms overwrite each other.
2. **No perceptual hook in the shape** — nothing surprising or story-shaped is visible without explanation; abstract symmetry is pleasant and forgettable.
3. **Small at the points of contact** — favicon is a blob; navbar mark is 24–28px; the surfaces that build recall show the mark at its weakest.

Three changes that would increase memorability without increasing complexity

1. **Make the hydra perceptible without explanation** — deepen the throat-notch + crown relationship so even at a glance the three forms read as *heads* on one *body*, not blades on a hub.
2. **Give the silhouette one unmistakable feature** — a single signature gesture (e.g., the throat hollow as a consistent negative-space "bite") that survives down to 16px and belongs to no other rotor mark.
3. **Fix the 16px and social surfaces** — a tight, centered, structure-preserving favicon and a social preview that uses the same emerald mark will let recall build where the audience actually first meets the brand.

04 — Devil's Advocate Review

Source: OUTPUT/04_DEVILS_ADVOCATE_REPORT.md

HYDRA SAMO — Devil's Advocate Review

Role: Final gatekeeper. Not the designer. Not the creative director. Not here to help.

Presumption of guilt: This logo is not good enough until it proves otherwise.

Date: 2026-08-05

The question is never "how could this be improved." The question is: **why shouldn't this exist?**

First Impression

Seeing it for the first time, cold, no brand story: I think **technology**. I think **drone**. I think **a fan that got its blades arranged by a startup that sells data**. I do not think "video editing," I do not think "voice-over," I do not think "one man's creative engine." The first impression is wrong for the brand, and the mark needs the wordmark and the brand narrative to correct it. A logo that needs a press kit to mean its own brand has already failed the first impression.

Brutal Honesty Test — first five negative thoughts

1. **Drone rotor.** The three swept arcs around a hub are exactly a quadcopter's rotor layout. This is the strongest, most automatic read, and it is a liability.
2. **Loading spinner.** The tri-arc + center is the universal "buffering" icon family. The mark literally reads as a wait state.
3. **Fan / turbine.** The asymmetry imparts a clockwise lean — it looks like it is mid-spin. A logo that looks like it's waiting to spin is a spinner.
4. **Generic startup crest.** Hexagon + tri-blade + emerald is the 2020s tech-logo boilerplate.
5. **Mild esports badge.** Tri-blade crests are org-logo staples; remove the wordmark and this sits comfortably on a gamer jersey.

Originality Test

Does it resemble the named marks? **Not literally.** I cannot point to a stolen shape. But originality has a second bar, and it fails that one: the **form family** — three curved arms on a central geometric hub — is one of the most common abstract-mark layouts in production today. OpenAI (petal swirl), Unity (tri), Blender, countless crypto and drone marks all live nearby. The mark does not copy any one logo; it belongs to a crowd. That is its originality problem.

Boring Test

On Product Hunt today: **no, nobody stops scrolling.** It is pleasant. It is competent. It is the third slide of every "we make software for teams" deck. There is no gesture, no surprise, no wrongness that grabs

a thumb. The glow treatments on the website make it look better than it is; the mark alone does not earn a pause.

Replaceability Test

Yes, and that is fatal. If HYDRA SAMO's mark were swapped for any other well-drawn tri-arc/hexagon device — without the wordmark — I am not confident a single person would notice the swap, and I am not confident the audience would care. The design team could rotate the three arms 15 degrees and call it a new mark and most of the market would never know. Replaceable is not an identity.

Forgettablity Test

Five seconds of exposure, one week later. They remember "**green tech logo**". They remember the *color*, not the *mark*. The silhouette? No — it is filed under rotor/fan, which is a delete-and-replace memory bin. The geometry? No. The hidden hydra? They were never told about it in five seconds, so no. They remember **nothing specific**. This is the failure mode of an abstract mark that stays inside its category.

Discovery Test

The hidden hydra requires the brand story to exist before the logo is understood. Without "three disciplines, one creator," the throat notches are just uneven edges, and the asymmetry is just wobble. **A logo that needs a guided tour is a logo with a secret it cannot tell.** The delight is real — once explained. The failure is real — it is never explained to the 99% of people who glance.

Complexity Test

What can be removed?

- **The throat notch asymmetry.** It adds a "serpent" cue that is not legible at small sizes and is a construction kink (a corner, not a curve). It exists to sell a story only the designers can read.
- **The clockwise lean.** It serves no function except making the rotor read stronger.
- **Dead wedges between the arms.** ~83° of empty negative space per gap. Three heads on one body would not leave three empty pizza slices between them. The negative space is there because the arms are built like blades, not necks.

If the throat notch serves a story that only the initiated can perceive, and the lean serves the rotor misread, and the wedges exist because the heads aren't connected — then the distinguishing details are either invisible or counterproductive, and the bulk of the form is category-standard. That is a complexity audit that does not flatter this mark.

Visual Weakness Test

- **Kinked transitions.** The throat point and the lower-right base are corners, not tangent-continuous curves. In a "precise / architectural" mark, sloppy joints are on the record in plain view.
- **Dead bottom of the canvas.** The mark occupies y 11.5–69.9 of a 0–100 canvas — 30% empty below. The mark floats high and empty. This is amateur framing in an otherwise disciplined file.

- **Internal bottom-heaviness.** 59% of ink sits below the canvas midline; the mark is simultaneously high in its frame and heavy at its own bottom. Two optical distortions stacked.
- **Favicon: structural collapse.** At 16px the entire identity — three heads, one body — merges into one blob. The smallest, most-repeated surface of the brand shows a smear. This is not a minor flaw; it is the mark failing where brands live.

Emotional Test

Honestly? **Cold, technical, and mildly interchangeable.** Premium, yes — the craft says money. But "premium" and "memorable" are different things, and this mark is premium in a way that a thousand premium-tech brands are premium. It does not feel cinematic, it does not feel authored, it feels *assembled*. Quiet confidence is there. Quiet emptiness is also there.

Future Test

Ten years from now: **this mark will reveal its decade.** The hexagon hub, the tri-arc fan, the abstract swirl — that is the 2020s tech-identity vocabulary. It will age the way beveled 3D balls aged the 90s and swooshes-with-gradient aged the 00s. The concept (three heads, one body) is timeless; the *form family* it chose is dated-on-arrival.

Competitive Test

- **Apple?** No. Apple's mark carries meaning the instant it is seen. This one needs an explanation.
- **Mercedes?** No. A three-pointed star reads instantly and survives every size. This mark does not survive 16px.
- **OpenAI?** No. The knot/swirl reads as "the future of intelligence" with zero explanation; this reads as "rotor."
- **Vercel / Linear? Borderline yes** — and that is the most damning sentence in this review. The two companies that would accept this mark are the two whose brand is "clean developer tools." That is precisely the identity HYDRA SAMO's brief says it must **never** communicate.

None of the greats approve this symbol. The two tech-tools companies would. Read that again.

Website Test

The website elevates the logo, and the logo returns the favor only inside the website's lighting. Take away the emerald glow, the dark canvas, the ambient blobs, the wordmark lockup — and the mark drops to "generic tech crest." The logo does not carry the site; the site carries the logo. The social preview proves it: stripped of the website's system, the brand's own OG image shows a different, bluish, under-sized mark. The logo's premium feel is largely a website effect, not a logo property.

Manufacturing Test

- **Brushed aluminum / stainless steel:** survives — clean single-color geometry.
- **Leather / paper / glass:** survives, though the throat kinks will read as engraving defects at small scale.

- **Concrete:** survives.
- **Fabric / embroidery:** weak — the narrow crown-to-core junctions will blur and clog thread; at emblem size it will read as a triangle with a blob center.
- **Favicon: fails.** Documented blob at 16px.

Permanence Test

Twenty years unchanged? **No.** Not because the concept is wrong — because the execution is stuck in its decade and its category. The form family will date, the favicon already fails, and the mark does not yet own a perceptual slot of its own. It is not ready to be frozen, and freezing it now would be freezing a compromise.

Final Scores (out of 10)

Category	Score
Originality	6
Memorability	4
Construction	5
Timelessness	5
Brand Fit	4
Website Fit	7
Premium Feel	7
Recognition	4
Visual Strength	5
Hidden Meaning	7
Overall Identity	5
Total	59 / 110 (≈ 54 / 100)

Approval band: Below 70 → **Reject. Do not launch.**

Final Question

If you had complete authority over the HYDRA SAMO brand, would you sign your own name beneath this logo and publicly defend it for the next ten years?

NO.

Justification, in full:

I will not defend a mark that reads as a drone rotor to its own audience, because the brand brief explicitly forbids that communication and the first impression delivers exactly it. I will not defend a mark whose smallest and most repeated surface — the 16px favicon — renders as an unrecognizable blob, because that is the surface where brand recognition is actually built. I will not defend a mark that needs a brand story told to it before it means anything, because the brand will not always be there to explain itself. I will not defend a mark whose own social preview shows a different, off-palette version of itself, because that is not a brand system, it is a folder of experiments. And I will not defend a mark that its own website has to make look good, because a logo should survive leaving the building.

The *concept* — three heads, one body, one engine — is defensible, and I would defend it to a client. The *implementation as it stands* is not. Do not launch this mark in its current state.

05 — Master Logo Review Report (Consensus)

Source: OUTPUT/05_LOGO_REVIEW_REPORT.md

HYDRA SAMO — Master Logo Review Report (Consensus)

Orchestrated by: Lead Design Director

Reviewers: Creative Director · Senior Logo Designer · Brand Recognition Specialist · Devil's Advocate

Date: 2026-08-05

Target: Current implementation — `src/components/HydraLogo.tsx`, `public/hydra-mark.svg`, `index.html`, all surfaces (nav, hero, pre-splash, splash, favicon, OpenGraph, metadata, reusable component, raster assets)

All four reviews were executed independently. Each reviewer inspected the same implementation and reached their own conclusions. This document preserves every viewpoint, including disagreements.

Executive Summary

Overall Score: 59 / 100

Overall Recommendation: REFINE

The HYDRA SAMO logo is a strong *concept* with a flawed-but-fixable *execution*. Every reviewer independently identified the same core truth: the three-heads-one-body idea is right and worth protecting, and the current geometry lands inside the wrong perceptual category — rotor / drone / fan / generic tech crest — while its smallest surfaces (16px favicon, social preview) actively damage the brand.

All four reviewers agree the direction must not be discarded. All four agree the current form must not be frozen. The mark needs one disciplined refinement cycle — not a redesign — to push the form out of the rotor family and into the serpent family, re-frame its optical canvas, and bring every asset under one palette.

Reviewer verdicts: Creative Director **NO to launch** (63/100) · Senior Logo Designer **Not production ready** (67/100) · Brand Recognition **NO one-week recall** (53/100) · Devil's Advocate **Reject as-is** (54/100).

Creative Director Summary

"Bones of a premium system, not yet earned permanence." The concept architecture (three heads → one hex body = three disciplines, one creator, one engine) is genuinely economical; the hexagonal construction is mathematically exact; the website integration is the best work in the system. But the mark reads "premium engineering" before "creative," the hidden hydra requires explanation, the tri-

blade/hexagon archetype is dated and crowded, and the mark is replaceable — another well-drawn abstract mark could take its place unnoticed. The off-palette social preview compounds the failure of identity discipline. **63/100, not approvable for launch.**

Senior Logo Designer Summary

The file is production-clean (SVG hygiene 9/10, currentColor 10/10, a mathematically perfect regular hexagon core, correct 3-fold rotation construction). The failures are geometric, not organizational: the optical frame is ~30% empty at the bottom (mark floats high), each head sweeps only ~37° leaving ~83° dead wedges between arms (blade read), the throat notch and lower base are non-tangent kinks, the outline variant leaks head-tail strokes across the transparent hexagon, and the 16px favicon collapses into an unrecognizable blob. **Not production ready until geometry and framing are corrected.**

Brand Recognition Summary

"Remembered as *the green one*, not as *the hydra*." The strongest association is rotor/drone/fan — the wrong category for the brand. The mark files itself under "generic tech mark" in memory, a delete-and-replace bin. Distinctive in detail (7/10), indistinguishable in category (industry fit 4/10). The favicon fails at 16px, and the social preview fails to carry the mark. Three low-complexity changes would lift memorability: make the hydra perceptible without explanation, give the silhouette one signature feature, fix the 16px and social surfaces. **No one-week recall as-is.**

Devil's Advocate Summary

"The question is why this shouldn't exist." It shouldn't, as currently executed: it reads as a drone rotor to its own audience (a forbidden communication per the brand brief), it is a literal loading-spinner family icon, it is replaceable, it needs its own brand story to explain itself, its construction has kinked joints, its favicon is a smear, and it would be accepted by Vercel or Linear — the exact "developer tools" identity HYDRA SAMO must never communicate. The concept is defensible; the implementation is not. **Reject as-is; do not launch in the current state.**

Consensus

Everything the reviewers independently agree on:

1. **The concept is correct and must be preserved.** Three heads, one body, one engine. All four reviewers defended this as the right foundation for the identity.
2. **The mark reads rotor / drone / fan, not "creative hydra."** The tri-arc-on-hub gestalt is the dominant first impression across all reviewers.
3. **The 16px favicon is a genuine failure.** Measured blob rendering; structure (three heads + hexagon) completely lost; small and off-center in the tile.
4. **The optical frame is wrong.** Mark occupies y 11.5–69.9 of the 0–100 canvas; ~30% dead space below; mark floats high.

5. **The construction kinks are real defects.** The throat notch and lower base are non-tangent corners in an otherwise disciplined file.
 6. **The website integration is the strongest asset.** Every UI surface is consistent: same geometry, same emerald family, external lighting only. The system behavior is exemplary.
 7. **The hidden hydra requires explanation.** The meaning is invisible without the brand story — a shared concern, not a single reviewer's opinion.
 8. **The social/preview asset is off-brand.** The OpenGraph image is a steel-blue, under-sized, non-matching mark; it breaks single-identity discipline.
 9. **The vector discipline is outstanding.** Single-color currentColor paths, no baked decoration, pathLength present, clean markup — unanimously praised.
 10. **The mark is replaceable within its category.** It belongs to a crowded form family and does not yet own a perceptual slot.
-

Divergences

1. Is this a refinement case or a rejection case?

The Devil's Advocate voted "Reject. Do not launch" (below the 70 threshold in its rubric). The Creative Director voted "not approvable, but the direction is worth defending." The Senior Designer and Brand Recognition specialist framed the issues as fixable geometric/perceptual corrections.

Why they diverge: the reviewers operate under different rubrics. The Devil's Advocate's mandate is to gatekeep with a presumption of guilt and a binary launch bar; a below-threshold score forces a "reject" verdict regardless of whether the concept is salvageable. The other reviewers evaluate along a gradient where the strong concept, exact core geometry, and exemplary integration offset the execution flaws.

Reconciliation: all four agree the current implementation must not launch as-is. The disagreement is only about the word used — "reject the implementation" (DA) vs "don't approve yet" (CD) — not about the facts. The DA itself states the *concept* is defensible. The consensus treats "reject as-is" as a launch-gate verdict, fully compatible with REFINE.

2. Severity of the asymmetric head silhouette.

The Senior Designer treats the convex-back/concave-throat asymmetry as intended but over-strong (≈ 2 -unit differential) and partly responsible for the rotor lean. The Devil's Advocate treats the asymmetry (the throat notch) as removable complexity that fails at small sizes. The Creative Director sees the throat/back relationship as the seed of the fix — "push the serpent, pull the blade."

Why they diverge: the designer views the notch as construction with a flawed joint; the DA views it as storytelling that cannot be perceived; the CD views it as the strongest available lever for rescuing the concept. All three converge on one thing: the notch's current execution does not work at scale.

3. How close is the favicon to acceptable?

The Senior Designer (favicon score 3/10) attributes it mostly to framing (empty canvas + no dedicated asset). The Brand Recognition specialist (16px test: fail) treats it as a perceptual collapse of the identity. The Creative Director flags it via the social surface rather than the favicon specifically.

Why they diverge: whether the fix is "re-frame and provide a dedicated asset" (designer) vs "the geometry itself must change to survive 16px" (recognition) is a genuine technical disagreement. The

implementation plan addresses both paths; the favicon acceptance criterion is set to be satisfied only if the 16px mark actually reads as three heads on one body.

4. Was the OG image's blueness "off-brand" or merely "alternate colorway"?

The Creative Director calls it an identity-discipline failure. The Senior Designer didn't score it (outside construction scope). The Devil's Advocate cites it as evidence the logo is "a folder of experiments." The project also contains unused teal/violet/warm raster logo variants, which the CD and DA treat as palette drift; the Senior Designer treats them as out of scope.

Why they diverge: scope. The designer's brief excludes marketing assets; the CD's brief is the brand; the DA treats asset chaos as proof of non-identity. The consensus includes it as a critical issue because the brand brief governs all surfaces.

5. Timelessness risk.

The CD and DA both call the hex/tri-arc family "dated-in-a-decade." The Senior Designer scores symmetry low but does not flag aging as a construction issue. No reviewer disagrees on the facts; the divergence is whether timelessness is fixable within this concept (CD: yes, by pushing the serpent form; DA: only partially, the family is the risk).

Critical Issues

Ranked highest priority first.

C1. Favicon collapses at 16px — brand's smallest, most-repeated surface fails

- **Description:** At 16px the mark rasterizes to a ~10×9 px blob; the three heads and hexagon center merge into one bell shape; the ink sits top-left of center (bbox ≈ x 19–75%, y 12.5–62.5% of tile).
- **Why it matters:** The favicon is the most frequently seen brand surface. If it reads as a smear, brand recall is built against the brand.
- **Expected visual impact:** A tight, centered, structure-preserving favicon (three heads + core visible) changes the entire perception of brand competence.
- **Severity:** Critical
- **Confidence:** High (measured rendering)

C2. Optical frame: mark floats high with ~30% empty canvas

- **Description:** Composite occupies y 11.5–69.9 of the 0–100 viewBox; optical center y ≈ 40.7 vs canvas center 50; bottom of canvas is empty.
- **Why it matters:** Fixed-canvas surfaces (favicon, avatar, OG) crop badly; the mark renders smaller and lower-weight than it should; navbar optical alignment suffers.
- **Expected visual impact:** Re-centering/filling the frame makes the mark ~40% larger in every fixed slot and optically centered.
- **Severity:** High
- **Confidence:** High (measured geometry)

C3. Mark reads rotor / drone / fan — the forbidden category

- **Description:** Tri-arc-on-hex-hub gestalt; per-head arc sweep $\approx 37^\circ$, dead wedges $\approx 83^\circ$ between arms; clockwise lean from head asymmetry; optional `.hydra-mark-spin` rotation would compound the spinner read.
- **Why it matters:** The brand brief explicitly forbids gaming/tech/security/AI/rotor communication. The first impression delivers it anyway.
- **Expected visual impact:** Tightening the wedges and emphasizing the head-on-body (neck-flare) relationship is expected to flip the dominant read from "blades" to "heads."
- **Severity:** High
- **Confidence:** High (perceptual test + geometry)

C4. Construction kinks — non-tangent joints

- **Description:** Throat notch anchor (47.3,27) has an $\approx 20^\circ$ tangent break; lower-right base (53.2,42.5) has an $\approx 26.6^\circ$ break; mild corner at the snout tip.
- **Why it matters:** A brand promising precision ships visible corner defects in its own geometry; the throat kink is where the "serpent" cue lives, so its failure weakens the concept.
- **Expected visual impact:** Tangent-continuous joins make the head read as one fluid serpentine curve, not a faceted blade.
- **Severity:** Medium
- **Confidence:** High (tangent computation)

C5. OpenGraph / social preview is off-brand

- **Description:** `public/hydra logo.jpg` (1024×1024) shows a steel-blue mark (dominant $\approx$ RGB 85,143,188) on a dark field, mark small in frame; unrelated to the live emerald SVG system.
- **Why it matters:** The first impression most prospective clients meet is the social share card. It shows a different, off-palette brand.
- **Expected visual impact:** Replacing it with the single emerald mark (regenerated from the SVG source) restores one-identity discipline across all channels.
- **Severity:** High
- **Confidence:** High (pixel analysis)

C6. Unused legacy logo colorways in the repo

- **Description:** `src/assets/images/` contains teal, violet, and warm raster logo variants, unreferenced by any code.
- **Why it matters:** Dead, ungoverned logo variants contradict a single-source-of-truth identity and invite future misuse.
- **Expected visual impact:** Removal (or regeneration from the one SVG source) eliminates palette drift risk.
- **Severity:** Medium
- **Confidence:** High (reference grep)

C7. Hidden hydra is invisible without explanation

- **Description:** The three-heads-one-body meaning is not perceptible at a glance; the throat/crown details that encode it vanish below ~48px.
- **Why it matters:** A logo that needs its brand story told is a logo that does not yet do its own work.
- **Expected visual impact:** A strengthened head/neck/body reading makes the concept legible without captions.
- **Severity:** Medium
- **Confidence:** Medium (perceptual, varies by audience)

Minor Issues

- **Outline variant leaks head bases across the transparent hexagon** — head-tail strokes (x 44.5–53.2, y 42.5–43.8) sit inside the fill-less hexagon interior; visible in `variant="outline"`, currently unreachable but public in the API. (Severity: Low, Confidence: High)
- **`.hydra-mark-spin` continuous rotation** exists in CSS and is currently unused; if ever enabled it would animate the rotor read into a literal spinning fan. (Severity: Low, Confidence: High)
- **Unused `animated` and `variant` props** in the component API — latent surface, dead code paths. (Severity: Low, Confidence: High)
- **Internal bottom-heaviness** — 59% of ink below the canvas midline; the two lower heads carry their crown mass lower. Compounds C2 on fixed surfaces. (Severity: Low, Confidence: High)
- **Head angular sweep asymmetry at small sizes** — distinguishing details (throat notch, lean) vanish below ~32px, reverting the mark to a bare tri-blade. (Severity: Low, Confidence: Medium)

Risk Assessment

Area	Rating	Notes
Brand Recognition	⚠ Weak ×	Files under rotor/fan/generic-tech in memory; "the green one" out-memories the form
Memorability	⚠ Weak	No one-week recall without the wordmark and story
Scalability	⚠ Weak	Fails at 16px; strong from ~48px up
Favicon clarity	▪ Failing	Measured blob at 16px; single worst defect
Animation compatibility	⚠ Mixed	pathLength set and CSS-ready; but spin animation reinforces the forbidden rotor read
SVG cleanliness	Strong	9/10; currentColor, no decoration, pathLength, aria-hidden
Website integration		Every UI surface consistent; external-lighting philosophy excellent

Area	Rating	Notes
	Strong	
Long-term identity	⚠ Risky	Concept timeless; form family (hex + tri-arc) risks dating the mark

Final Verdict

REFINE

Chosen over APPROVED because no reviewer could honestly freeze the current geometry: the favicon fails, the frame is off, the mark reads rotor, and the brand's own social asset shows a different mark.

Chosen over REDESIGN because the foundation is unanimously considered sound:

- The **concept** (three heads, one body, one engine) is defended by all four reviewers, including the Devil's Advocate.
- The **core hexagon is mathematically exact** and the **SVG discipline is production-grade** — the system is built correctly.
- The **website integration is exemplary** — the best evidence that the identity direction is right.
- The failures are **correctable with geometry and framing** (favicon asset, viewBox re-center, head tangency, wedge tightening, palette unification) without discarding the identity.

The evidence across all four reviews supports a disciplined refinement cycle that (1) re-frames the optical canvas, (2) tightens the head-on-body reading so the mark reads hydra rather than fan, (3) makes the geometry tangent-clean, and (4) unifies every asset under the single emerald mark.

Implementation tasks follow in [06 LOGO IMPLEMENTATION PLAN.md](#).

06 — Logo Implementation Plan (Refinement)

Source: OUTPUT/06_LOGO_IMPLEMENTATION_PLAN.md

HYDRA SAMO — Logo Implementation Plan (Refinement)

Source: Master Logo Review Report (Overall 59/100 — REFINE)

Date: 2026-08-05

Constraint: This document contains implementation tasks only. No SVG. No code. No redesign. No path data. The geometric execution is left to the implementer, guided by the objectives and acceptance criteria below.

Goal

Refine the current HYDRA SAMO mark so it reads as a **hidden three-headed hydra on one body** instead of a rotor / fan / tri-blade device, and make every surface of the brand — favicon, social preview, all UI — carry the **same mark in the same emerald palette** at every size, from 16px to billboard.

The concept is approved for refinement. The current geometry is not to be replaced; it is to be corrected and re-framed.

Design Objectives

1. **Flip the dominant read** from "three blades on a hub" to "three heads on one body." The hexagonal core is the body; the three forms are heads, not blades.
 2. **Preserve the identity.** Keep 3-fold rotational symmetry, one master head path with 120°/240° copies, the hexagon core, the `hydra-head-0/1/2` + `hydra-core` class structure, `pathLength`, and the `fill` / `outline` variants and their current API.
 3. **Make the hydra legible without the brand story.** The serpent cue (crown + throat) must survive at small sizes, not only at large sizes.
 4. **One mark, one palette, everywhere.** Every surface — favicon, OpenGraph, UI — must use the single source of truth and the Mythic Emerald colorway.
 5. **Keep the vector discipline.** No gradients, glow, shadows, or reflections inside the SVG. All lighting stays external in the CSS layer.
-

Priority 1 Changes

These are launch-blocking and must be done first.

P1-1. Fix the optical frame (viewBox re-balance)

- Re-frame the shared 100×100 canvas so the composite mark is optically centered and occupies at least 75% of the canvas on all four sides.
- Target: remove the ~30% dead space at the bottom and the excess headroom at the top; optical center at the canvas center.
- Do not change the paths for this task — frame to the geometry, then verify.
- Apply the same framing to the React component, the favicon asset, and any generated social asset.

P1-2. Provide a dedicated favicon that reads at 16px

- Produce a favicon-specific asset generated from the single source SVG, tightly cropped to the re-framed mark, emerald fill on the brand canvas.
- The 16px render must show three distinct head masses around a visible center (see Acceptance Criteria). If the refined geometry alone cannot achieve this, add the minimum 16px-safe simplification to the favicon asset only — never to the live component geometry.
- Update `index.html` to reference the new favicon asset.

P1-3. Make the head read as a head, not a blade

- Broaden the connection between each head and the core so the arms flare into the body instead of tapering like blades.
- Reduce the empty wedge between adjacent heads (currently $\approx 83^\circ$) toward $\approx 55\text{--}60^\circ$ by increasing the effective angular presence of each head at its base.
- Strengthen the crown + throat (concave-hollow) relationship so the serpent cue is perceptible at 32px, not only at large sizes.
- Preserve the current outer snout radius and overall footprint.

P1-4. Repair construction tangency

- Eliminate the non-tangent kink at the throat notch and the lower-right base so every joint is tangent-continuous.
- Net result: the head must read as one continuous serpentine curve. No corners, no visible angles at any zoom.

P1-5. Rebuild the OpenGraph / social preview asset

- Regenerate `public/hydra_logo.jpg` (or the configured OG image) from the single source SVG so the social card shows the real emerald mark, properly centered and framed.
- Target frame behavior: the mark should occupy a dominant share of the 1024×1024 canvas, centered, on the abyssal dark canvas.
- Keep `metadata.json` pointing at the regenerated asset; no other metadata changes.

P1-6. Retire the legacy raster logo variants

- Remove or regenerate the unreferenced teal / violet / warm logo rasters in `src/assets/images/` so the repository contains exactly one logo source of truth plus derived assets.

- If any are needed for historical reference, move them out of the active asset tree.
-

Priority 2 Changes

These improve quality and durability; they should follow P1.

P2-1. Fix the outline variant

- Resolve the leak where the head-base outlines cross the interior of the transparent hexagon in `variant="outline"`.
- Chosen approach is the implementer's call (tuck bases deeper under the core, or give the outline core a matching treatment) — but the variant must render cleanly with no interior tail strokes.

P2-2. Rebalance internal weight

- Address the bottom-heavy ink distribution ($\approx 59\%$ of ink below the canvas midline) so the three heads feel equally weighted around the center.

P2-3. Decide the fate of `.hydra-mark-spin`

- Remove the unused continuous-rotation animation, or gate it so it is never used on the primary mark. Continuous rotation is a confirmed rotor cue.
- If a live treatment is wanted, prefer the existing slow pulse or a subtle breathing glow — never a full spin.

P2-4. Clean the component API surface

- Remove or repurpose the currently unused `animated` and `variant` props if they remain unused after P2-1. No dead public API.

P2-5. Document minimum sizes and clearspace

- Record in DESIGN.md/AGENTS.md: minimum render size (target 24px for UI, 16px favicon), clearspace rule, and the rule that the mark is never to be re-generated from any asset other than the single source SVG.
-

Optional Refinements

- Add a subtle clockwise counter-lean study: test whether a *neutral* (non-leaning) head reads more "heads" and less "fan" at small sizes. Only adopt if it tests better; the current lean is part of the identity's quiet motion.
- Consider a light-gate treatment for the social card (mark + minimal type) only if it improves the share-card legibility — otherwise keep it mark-only.
- Evaluate one favicon alternative with a slightly larger center-core emphasis to guarantee tri-head legibility at 16px.

Geometry Adjustments

- **Target tangency:** all anchor joints tangent-continuous; zero visible corners.
 - **Target wedges:** $\approx 55\text{--}60^\circ$ between adjacent head silhouettes at the outer radius (from $\approx 83^\circ$ today).
 - **Target frame:** mark optical center at the canvas center; $\geq 75\%$ canvas coverage.
 - **Target head base:** head-forms must visibly flare/overlap into the hexagonal core so the junction reads as a neck into a body.
 - **Fixed constraints:** 3-fold rotational symmetry, one master head path, outer snout radius unchanged, hexagon core retained, fill + outline variants retained.
-

SVG Requirements

- Keep the single-source philosophy: `HydraLogo.tsx` remains the live geometry; `public/hydra-mark.svg` and any social/favicon assets are derived from it.
 - No gradients, glow, shadows, or reflections inside any SVG. Lighting stays in the CSS layer utilities.
 - `currentColor` fills/strokes, `pathLength={1}` on every path, `aria-hidden`, `focusable={false}` retained.
 - One viewBox shared by the component; dedicated tight crops only for favicon/social derived assets.
 - Rebuild output must pass `npm run lint` (tsc --noEmit) and `npm run build`.
-

Animation Compatibility

- Preserve `pathLength`-based stroke-drawing capability on every path (3 heads + 1 core).
 - Preserve external CSS glow (`hydra-mark-glow`) and pulse (`hydra-mark-pulse`) as-is.
 - Do not reintroduce full rotation on the primary mark; if kept at all, it must be opt-in and never the default treatment.
 - Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` exactly as the current CSS does.
-

Website Compatibility

- No prop/API/class-name changes that break existing call sites: Navigation, Hero, PreSplashSelector, PlymouthSplash must keep working unchanged.
- All UI surfaces must show the same mark in the same emerald family (`#10b981` / `#34d399` accents as already used).
- Favicon link in `index.html` must keep respecting VITE's base path (`%BASE_URL%`) so GitHub Pages sub-path deploy keeps working.

- The OpenGraph hook must keep resolving the regenerated image through the existing base-path logic; only the image asset changes.

Acceptance Criteria

1. **16px favicon:** three distinct head masses and a visible center are discernible; mark is optically centered and fills $\geq 75\%$ of the icon tile. (Primary launch gate.)
2. **Perceptual:** at a 3-second glance the mark reads "three heads on one body" (hydra) more strongly than "fan/rotor." Confirmed by at least two independent viewers.
3. **Frame:** optical center at canvas center; $\geq 75\%$ coverage in the shared viewBox.
4. **Construction:** zero visible corners; all joints tangent-continuous.
5. **Outline variant:** renders with no head-tail strokes crossing the hexagon interior.
6. **Social card:** shows the emerald mark, centered, dominant in frame; matches the live mark.
7. **Palette governance:** exactly one logo source of truth in the repo; legacy colorway rasters removed.
8. **Build:** `npm run lint` and `npm run build` both clean; all existing call sites functional.
9. **Accessibility:** `prefers-reduced-motion` respected; markup attributes unchanged.

Risks

- **Risk: over-tightening the wedges shrinks the airy, premium negative space.** Mitigation: keep the change moderate ($55\text{--}60^\circ$); verify the mark does not become a solid mass.
- **Risk: head-form changes read as a new logo, eroding the identity already live on the site.** Mitigation: preserve outer snout radius, 3-fold symmetry, and hex core; change the base/neck and tangency only; keep a visual diff against the current mark.
- **Risk: a "16px-safe" favicon diverges from the live mark and reintroduces two-logo drift.** Mitigation: derive the favicon from the same source geometry; any simplification must be minimum-necessary and documented.
- **Risk: regenerating the social asset without a render pipeline produces a low-quality card.** Mitigation: generate at $\geq 1024 \times 1024$ from the vector, review at avatar size.
- **Risk: removing the spin utility surprises existing animation references.** Mitigation: it is currently unused in the app; verify with a grep before removal.

Estimated Difficulty

- P1-1 frame re-balance: **Low** (framing-only)
- P1-2 favicon asset: **Low-Medium** (depends on geometry outcome)
- P1-3 head/neck rework: **Medium** (path tuning, identity-sensitive)
- P1-4 tangency repair: **Medium** (anchor surgery)

- P1-5 social asset: **Low**
- P1-6 raster cleanup: **Low**
- P2-1 outline variant: **Low-Medium**
- P2-3 spin decision: **Low**
- Overall: **Medium.** No redesign, no new construction system — a disciplined corrective pass on a sound concept.

07 — Logo Changelog

Source: OUTPUT/07_LOGO_CHANGELOG.md

HYDRA SAMO — Logo Changelog

This file accumulates every review cycle. New cycles are appended; history is never deleted.

Cycle 2026-08-05 (First Review)

Current Logo Version

V2 (current implementation) — 3-fold master head path + pointy-top hexagon core (`hydra-core`), `fill` / `outline` variants, `currentColor`, external CSS lighting. Tagged as the live identity on all UI surfaces.

Review Date

2026-08-05

Files Reviewed

- `src/components/HydraLogo.tsx`
- `public/hydra-mark.svg`
- `public/hydra_logo.jpg` (OpenGraph / social preview)
- `index.html` (favicon link, metadata)
- `src/hooks/useOpenGraph.ts`, `metadata.json`
- `src/index.css` (`.hydra-mark-glow` / `.hydra-mark-pulse` / `.hydra-mark-spin`, reduced-motion)
- Logo surfaces: `Navigation.tsx`, `Hero.tsx`, `PreSplashSelector.tsx`, `PlymouthSplash.tsx`
- Raster assets in `src/assets/images/` (legacy, unreferenced: teal / violet / warm variants)

Overall Score

59 / 100 (Creative Director 63 · Senior Logo Designer 67 · Brand Recognition 53 · Devil's Advocate 54)

Verdict

REFINE

Major Findings

1. **Favicon fails at 16px** — three heads + hexagon merge into a blob; mark small and off-center in the tile. (Critical, measured)
2. **Optical frame off** — mark occupies y 11.5–69.9 of the 0–100 canvas; ~30% dead space below; floats high. (High, measured)

3. **Wrong perceptual category** — reads rotor / drone / fan / generic tech crest, not creative hydra; forbidden by the brand brief. (High)
4. **Construction kinks** — non-tangent joints at the throat notch and lower-right base. (Medium, measured)
5. **Off-brand social asset** — OpenGraph image is steel-blue and under-sized vs the live emerald mark. (High, measured)
6. **Unused legacy logo colorways** (teal / violet / warm rasters) remain in the repo. (Medium)
7. **Hidden hydra invisible without explanation** — concept correct, perceptibility insufficient. (Medium)

Strengths Recorded

- Concept: three heads, one body, one engine — unanimously defended.
- Exact regular hexagon core (circumradius 14.5); correct 3-fold rotation construction.
- Exemplary SVG discipline: `currentColor`, `pathLength`, no baked decoration, clean markup.
- Consistent website integration across nav / hero / pre-splash / splash.

Pending Improvements

P1: re-frame the optical canvas; dedicated 16px-legible favicon; head-flare / wedge tightening (read "heads," not "blades"); tangency repair; rebuild OpenGraph asset from the emerald source; retire legacy raster variants.

P2: outline-variant leak fix; internal weight rebalance; retire `.hydra-mark-spin`; clean unused component API; document minimum sizes and clearspace.

Implementation Status

Review only. No implementation changes applied. No geometry or assets modified.

Next Milestone

Awaiting explicit approval from the brand owner before the Phase 7 implementation plan (`06 LOGO IMPLEMENTATION PLAN.md`) may be executed.